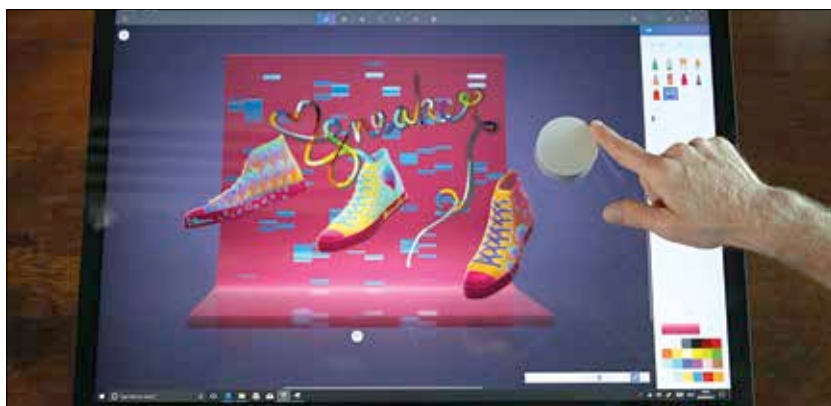




artwork for flyers, to making storyboards or generating the required images for presentations. What it allows you to do is choose from a large library of 3D objects and position them in 3D space to create a final image. If you have created assets from any other 3D software for say, making a video game or 3D printing, then Paint can also work as a quick and dirty texture painting software. Basically, check out Paint 3D and you might find some surprising uses for it.

MOUNT A HARD DRIVE

If an external HDD is not showing up or an internal one has suddenly gone missing, there is a simple way to make it show up on Explorer again. Fire up run using **Windows + R** and type in `diskmgmt.msc`. This brings up the Disk Management app that lists all the connected hard drives as well

as the partitions on them, whether or not they are mounted, that is assigned a drive letter in Explorer. Right click on the missing drive and select **Mark Partition as Active** and then **Change Drive Letter and Paths**. This will make the hard drive show up in Explorer, and allow you to access your files. The app can be used to manage all kinds of things with hard drives, such as formatting them, changing the drive letters and changing the size of the partitions. Make sure that all your files are backed up and that you can reinstall the OS before fiddling around with these settings.

MANAGE STARTUP APPS

Over time, the software that you install may have small agents for accessory services that initiate on startup, and slow down how long your machine takes to turn on and for you

to start working. To make the startup faster, a simple hack is to remove all unnecessary processes from initiating automatically when the machine boots up. To do this, bring up the Task Manager and switch to the Startup tab. Instead of **Ctrl + Alt + Delete**, a simpler and faster way to do this is simply right click on the taskbar and select **Task Manager**. Take a look at the impact of the different software, which will be sorted into Low, Medium and High. Go ahead and remove all the services, and disable them from the startup. For example, we had Skype, OneDrive, Vivaldi, Spotify, Steam and Winamp all listed here, and disabled them. All these software work as intended even when they are disabled at startup.

SHOW DAY IN TASKBAR

By default, the system clock in the bottom right corner shows only the time, and not the day, which can be something useful to spot at a glance. Fire up Control Panel, then go to **Region > Clock & Region > Region > Additional Settings > Date** and in the short date format, add `ddd/` before the `M/d/yyyy`. Now, in the taskbar, the day of the week should be visible. Another easy way to make changes to the day and date settings is to fire up the Registry Editor, go to **Computer > HKEY_CURRENT_USER > Control Panel > International** and manually edit the `sShortDate` entry. Any text that you feed in here not indicating the calendar format will be displayed on the taskbar as is, which can also be used to irritate or prank someone. Note that unfortunately, this method does not work if you have toggled the **Use smaller taskbar buttons** to **On**.

GET NOTIFICATIONS ON YOUR COMPUTER

This was a feature that was initially available only for Android users, but is now available to iOS users as well. Go to **Settings > Phone** and follow the device specific instructions of linking your phone to your PC. Once set up, you unlock a whole range of additional features depending on the OS of your device. You can continue browsing web pages on either

